

Solventum

Business Development Dossier

Industry	Healthcare / Medical Technology
Revenue	\$8.4B
Employees	22,000
Ideal Customer Profile Score	91

ICP SCORING MODEL



ICP = Signals + Revenue + Employees + Fit (max 100)

Signals (0-35)	Top 4 signals scored; each = base(60%) + recency bonus <30d: 40% <90d: 30% <180d: 20% older: 10%
Revenue (0-25)	\$500M-\$10B sweet spot -> 70-100% of 25 pts Below \$500M -> pro-rata x 0.5 Above \$10B -> 60%
Employees (0-20)	2,000+ preferred (70-100%) 500-2K partial (50-70%) Below 500 -> pro-rata x 0.3
Fit (0-20)	High-fit types: reorg, transformation, M&A, hiring, funding, partnership -> 5 pts ea (max 12) + diversity 2/type (max 8)

Prepared March 19, 2026

McChrystal Group

Leadership Advisory & Organizational Effectiveness

SECTION 1

Organization Snapshot

Legal Name	Solventum Corporation
Headquarters	Maplewood, Minnesota
Founded	2024

Ownership

Public (NYSE: SOLV); formerly 3M Health Care business. Activist investor Trian Partners (Nelson Peltz) holds significant stake

Footprint

Operations in 30+ countries; manufacturing facilities across North America, Europe, and Asia; R&D centers in the U.S. and globally

SECTION 1b

Company Overview

Solventum is a global healthcare technology company spun off from 3M in April 2024, operating across four segments: MedSurg, Dental Solutions, Health Information Systems, and Purification & Filtration (divested 2025). With \$8.4B in 2025 revenue and 22,000 employees across 30+ countries, Solventum is navigating the complexities of building a standalone operating model while executing a \$500M cost transformation program under activist investor pressure from Trian Partners.

SECTION 2

Financial Health & Growth Stage

Understanding Solventum's financial position and trajectory is critical to framing any engagement conversation.

Revenue: \$8.4B in 2025, representing 2.8% organic growth. Q4 2025 organic growth accelerated.

Profitability: Adjusted operating margins expanding; 'Transform for the Future' program targeting 50-100 basis point expansion in 2026 with \$500M in total annual savings by 2029.

Debt: Reduced from \$8.3B to ~\$4.2B by end of 2025 using Purification & Filtration divestiture proceeds. Net debt-to-EBITDA ratio improved to 1.9x - ahead of schedule.

Analyst Sentiment: Mixed. Stock recovered 20%+ in 2025 after a rough start. Trian Partners initially called performance 'alarming' but the company demonstrated execution. 2026 guidance: 2-3% organic sales growth, margin expansion.

Key Pressures: Product rebranding from 3M logo (hundreds of millions in cost, deadline 2027); tariff headwinds (\$60-80M estimated in 2026); activist investor scrutiny; IT system separation from 3M infrastructure.

Key Tailwinds: Debt reduction ahead of schedule; cost transformation gaining momentum; Acera Surgical acquisition contributing to growth; strong position in wound care and surgical solutions.

SECTION 3

Leadership Team Profiles

The following contacts are recommended as primary outreach targets - champion-level leaders who feel the organizational pain daily and can sponsor McChrystal internally.

Mojdeh Poul - Executive Vice President, MedSurg [PRIORITY TARGET]

Former 3M executive; leads largest business segment

Outreach rationale: Leads the largest business segment (MedSurg) and is closest to the operational transformation challenges - IT separation, manufacturing standardization, and 3M logo rebranding across thousands of products. Natural champion for McChrystal engagement.

Anita Zielinski - SVP, Chief Human Resources Officer [PRIORITY TARGET]

Building standalone HR function and culture post-spinoff

Outreach rationale: Owns the people side of the transformation - culture building for a new standalone company, talent retention during activist pressure, and organizational design across 22,000 employees in 30+ countries.

Additional leadership team members relevant to the engagement:

Bryan Hanson - Chief Executive Officer

Former CEO of Zimmer Biomet; deep medtech operating experience

Wayde McMillan - Chief Financial Officer

Recruited from GE HealthCare; financial transformation expertise

John Banovetz - Chief Technology Officer

Former 3M CTO; leading R&D and innovation strategy

SECTION 4

Organizational Culture & Structure

Culture and structure are often where McChrystal Group finds the deepest leverage. The following signals indicate how Solventum operates today and where friction exists.

Organizational Structure

Matrixed global organization transitioning from 3M divisional structure to standalone. Four business segments: MedSurg, Dental Solutions, Health Information Systems, and (divested) Purification & Filtration. Currently building standalone corporate functions (IT, HR, Finance, Legal) that were previously shared with 3M.

Culture Signals

Post-Spinoff Identity Crisis: Solventum is in the difficult position of building a new corporate identity while most

employees spent their careers as '3M people.' The cultural challenge of creating shared consciousness in a newly independent company - where functional expertise was previously borrowed from the parent - is significant.

Activist Pressure: Trian Partners' public criticism in January 2025 created internal anxiety. Leadership turnover as new C-suite replaces legacy 3M executives adds to uncertainty.

Glassdoor Signals: [INFERRED] Typical post-spinoff patterns - mixed reviews reflecting transition anxiety, concerns about direction, but optimism about independence and new leadership.

Transformation Fatigue Risk: Employees simultaneously navigating: new company identity, new leadership, new systems (IT separation), new processes (cost transformation), and rebranding - classic change saturation risk.

SECTION 5

Recent News & Trigger Events

The following developments from the past 18 months create urgency and provide natural conversation entry points for engaging Solventum.

1. 2024-04-01 - Completed spinoff from 3M; began trading as independent company on NYSE

Created a 22,000-person organization that must build standalone capabilities from scratch - foundational organizational design moment

2. 2025-01-01 - Trian Partners (Nelson Peltz) publicly criticized performance as 'alarming'; pushed for accelerated transformation

Activist pressure creates urgency and board-level accountability for organizational execution - increases willingness to engage external advisors

3. 2025-06-01 - Divested Purification & Filtration business; used proceeds to reduce debt by ~\$4B

Portfolio simplification creates organizational redesign requirement - functions previously supporting four segments must be right-sized for three

4. 2025-12-01 - Acquired Acera Surgical; CEO declared 'purposeful and intense' pace of execution

Simultaneous acquisition integration while executing cost transformation tests organizational capacity - classic McChrystal 'too many priorities' challenge

5. 2026-01-01 - 2026 guidance issued: 2-3% organic growth, 50-100bp margin expansion; Transform for the Future ramping

Transformation program entering critical execution phase - moving from planning to cross-functional delivery across 30+ countries

6. 2025-06-01 - Must remove 3M logo from thousands of products globally by 2027; rebranding costs estimated in hundreds of millions

Massive cross-functional coordination challenge spanning manufacturing, regulatory, marketing, and supply chain across every geography

SECTION 6

McChrystal Fit Assessment

Multiple active trigger events (spinoff, activist pressure, cost transformation, acquisition, rebranding) create compounding organizational complexity. Clear economic buyers at SVP level. Revenue \$8.4B supports premium advisory spend. Urgency is real (2027 rebranding deadline, activist pressure). The gap between what McKinsey delivers (cost strategy) and what Solventum needs (operating model execution) is McChrystal's exact lane.

Primary Problem

Building a standalone operating model for a 22,000-person global company while simultaneously executing a \$500M cost transformation, integrating an acquisition, rebranding thousands of products, and managing activist investor pressure - all within compressed timelines.

Best McChrystal Capability Fit

Team of Teams operating model and organizational design - Solventum needs to create shared consciousness across newly independent functions that previously relied on 3M's corporate infrastructure. McChrystal's cross-functional alignment methodology directly addresses the coordination gaps emerging as standalone systems replace shared services.

Likely Objections to Engagement

We already have McKinsey/BCG advising on the cost transformation (likely given \$500M scope)
 Budget constraints - activist pressure means every dollar of advisory spend is scrutinized
 Leadership team is new and still establishing authority - may resist additional external voices
 Post-spinoff fatigue - employees may resist yet another change initiative

Competitive Advisory Landscape

McKinsey & Company - likely advising on Transform for the Future cost program
 Deloitte - probable IT separation and systems integration partner
 Korn Ferry - potential leadership assessment and organizational design
 BCG - could be involved in portfolio strategy post-divestiture

SECTION 7

Conversation Entry Points

These questions are designed for a Senior Partner's first conversation. Each opens a thread that naturally leads to McChrystal Group's capabilities without a direct pitch.

1. As you build Solventum's standalone operating model, what's been the hardest part of creating cross-functional alignment without the 3M infrastructure you used to rely on?

Position as a peer conversation about the unique challenges of post-spinoff organizational design - something McChrystal has deep pattern recognition on from military and corporate transformations.

2. With Transform for the Future ramping up alongside the 3M logo rebranding and Acera integration, how are you prioritizing when everything feels urgent?

Demonstrate understanding of the specific sequencing challenge - too many simultaneous priorities is the exact problem McChrystal's operating model solves.

3. How is the new leadership team building shared identity and culture when most of your 22,000 people still think of themselves as '3M employees'?

Touch the emotional/cultural dimension that pure strategy consultants miss - culture is McChrystal's differentiator.

Recommended Meeting Framing

Frame as a 20-minute conversation about what McChrystal has learned from helping other post-spinoff and post-transformation organizations build the operating model that lets strategy actually execute. Emphasize pattern recognition from similar situations (high-stakes, multi-front transformation under external pressure) rather than selling a methodology.

SECTION 8

Brand Insights & Market Positioning

Brand strategy reveals organizational priorities and coordination challenges. The following analysis connects Solventum's market positioning to potential McChrystal engagement opportunities.

Brand Identity Evolution: Solventum is in the rare position of being a well-known company that nobody has heard of. Its products (wound care, surgical supplies, dental materials) are trusted by healthcare professionals worldwide - but under the 3M brand. The transition to the Solventum brand is not just a logo swap; it's an organizational identity challenge. Every product, every sales conversation, every regulatory filing must transition.

Brand Value: The 3M Health Care brand carried decades of trust and recognition. Solventum must build equivalent brand equity from zero in a compressed timeline - while the 3M logo on products creates customer confusion about whether quality or ownership has changed.

Marketing Leadership: [INFERRED] CMO/Chief Marketing Officer role is critical during rebranding but details are limited. The marketing team is essentially running two brands simultaneously during transition.

Brand Threats: Customer confusion during the 3M-to-Solventum transition; competitor messaging suggesting instability; regulatory re-approval requirements in some markets where brand name is part of the product registration.

McChrystal Connection: The rebranding challenge is fundamentally an organizational coordination problem - manufacturing, regulatory, marketing, sales, and supply chain must all execute in sync across 30+ countries and thousands of SKUs. A brand promise of reliability and quality requires operational coordination to deliver. This is exactly the kind of cross-functional challenge McChrystal's operating model addresses.

SECTION 9

Deep McChrystal Group Fit Analysis

This is the strategic case for pursuing Solventum. It synthesizes findings from all previous sections into a comprehensive engagement thesis with specific fit dimensions, expected outcomes, stakeholder mapping, and a phased pursuit strategy.

9a. Fit Dimensions

Fit Dimension 1: Post-Spinoff Operating Model Design

Solventum must build every corporate function (IT, HR, Finance, Legal, Procurement) from scratch while maintaining uninterrupted service to healthcare customers who depend on reliable supply. McKinsey can design the org chart; McChrystal builds the operating rhythm, information flow, and decision-making architecture that makes the org chart actually work. Timing: Critical now - the first 24 months post-spinoff set patterns that persist for decades.

Fit Dimension 2: Multi-Front Transformation Coordination

Solventum is simultaneously executing: (1) \$500M cost transformation, (2) IT system separation from 3M, (3) product rebranding across thousands of SKUs, (4) Acera Surgical integration, (5) debt reduction, and (6) cultural transformation under activist pressure. No single consulting firm can own all six - but McChrystal can build the cross-functional coordination system that prevents them from colliding. Deloitte handles IT separation; McKinsey handles cost; McChrystal connects them.

Fit Dimension 3: Activist-Driven Urgency and Board Accountability

Trihan Partners creates a forcing function that traditional advisory relationships don't face. Every initiative must demonstrate measurable progress on compressed timelines. McChrystal's operating rhythm (daily standups, weekly integration reviews, rapid decision cycles) maps directly to the cadence that activist-pressured boards demand - and that traditional consulting deliverables (quarterly strategy decks) fail to provide.

Fit Dimension 4: Global Rebranding as Organizational Coordination Challenge

Removing 3M from thousands of products across 30+ countries by 2027 is not a marketing project - it's the largest cross-functional coordination challenge in Solventum's short history. Manufacturing, regulatory, marketing, sales, supply chain, and legal must all execute in sync. McChrystal's shared consciousness model was designed for exactly this kind of multi-domain coordination under time pressure.

9b. Cumulative Case - Why Solventum Is a Top Pipeline Opportunity

Solventum represents the highest-complexity organizational transformation in the healthcare sector: a \$8.4B company that didn't exist 2 years ago, under activist pressure, executing a \$500M cost program, rebranding thousands of products, building standalone IT systems, integrating an acquisition, and trying to create a new corporate identity - all simultaneously. Each dimension amplifies the others: cost transformation requires cross-functional alignment -> which requires a functioning operating model -> which doesn't exist yet because they're still separating from 3M -> while activists demand faster execution.

Revenue Potential: \$500K initial diagnostic/operating model design (3-month engagement), expandable to

\$1.5M-\$2M for enterprise-wide operating rhythm implementation across key segments, with \$500K-\$1M ongoing retainer for transformation cadence management. Total opportunity: \$2.5M-\$3.5M over 18-24 months.

9c. Enterprise Issues & Organizational Challenges

1. **Standalone Operating Model Gap:** Solventum's corporate functions (IT, HR, Finance, Procurement) were designed to operate within 3M's infrastructure. The Transitional Services Agreements (TSAs) with 3M are temporary - as they expire, Solventum must have standalone capabilities ready. Gaps between TSA expiration and standalone readiness create operational risk.
2. **Change Saturation Across 22,000 Employees:** Employees are simultaneously navigating new corporate identity, new leadership, new systems, new processes, and uncertainty about headcount reductions from the cost program. Classic transformation fatigue - productivity drops when people can't predict what changes next.
3. **Cross-Functional Coordination Deficits:** Without 3M's established cross-functional coordination mechanisms (shared services, common IT systems, centralized planning), Solventum's business segments risk operating as silos. The MedSurg team may not know what Dental Solutions is doing - creating duplicate efforts and missed synergies.
4. **Activist-Management Trust Deficit:** Trian's public criticism creates a board dynamic where every management decision faces additional scrutiny. This slows decision-making at exactly the moment when speed is essential. Leaders become risk-averse to avoid activist criticism.
5. **Global Rebranding Execution Risk:** Removing 3M from thousands of product SKUs across 30+ countries requires synchronized execution across manufacturing (new packaging), regulatory (re-filings where brand name is part of approval), marketing (customer communication), sales (updated materials), and supply chain (inventory management of old vs. new branded products). Any misalignment creates customer confusion and regulatory risk.
6. **Acquisition Integration While Transforming:** Integrating Acera Surgical while simultaneously building standalone capabilities creates competing demands on the same leadership bandwidth. Integration playbooks that work for established companies don't work for companies that are themselves being built.
7. **Leadership Team Cohesion:** A C-suite recruited almost entirely from outside (Medtronic, GE HealthCare, Zimmer Biomet) must build trust, shared language, and operating norms from scratch - while under activist scrutiny and leading 22,000 employees through unprecedented change.

9d. Expected Outcomes from McChrystal Group Engagement

1. **Enterprise Operating Rhythm:** Design and implement a cross-functional operating cadence (daily standups, weekly integration reviews, monthly transformation milestones) that connects all six transformation workstreams. Measurable: reduce cross-functional decision-making cycle time by 40-60%.
2. **Shared Consciousness Framework:** Build the information-sharing architecture that ensures MedSurg, Dental, and HIS segments coordinate rather than operate independently. Measurable: eliminate 50%+ of duplicate initiatives identified in first 90 days.
3. **Rebranding Coordination System:** Design the cross-functional coordination mechanism for the 3M logo removal program - connecting manufacturing, regulatory, marketing, sales, and supply chain across all geographies. Measurable: achieve 95%+ on-time milestone completion for rebranding program.

4. Change Absorption Capacity: Build organizational resilience frameworks that prevent transformation fatigue from degrading operational performance. Measurable: maintain employee engagement scores within 5% of baseline during peak transformation activity.
5. Leadership Team Alignment: Facilitate rapid trust-building and shared operating norms for the newly assembled C-suite. Measurable: reduce time from strategic decision to aligned execution from weeks to days.
6. Activist-Ready Execution Reporting: Create transformation scorecards that give the board (and Trian) real-time visibility into execution progress - replacing quarterly narrative updates with outcome-based metrics. Measurable: board confidence scores on transformation execution.

9e. Key Stakeholders & Business Unit Map

MedSurg

Leader: Mojdeh Poul, EVP

Function: Largest segment - surgical, wound care, infection prevention

McChrystal Relevance: Priority: Highest rebranding complexity, most SKUs, most geographies

Dental Solutions

Leader: [TBD]

Function: Dental materials, orthodontics, digital dentistry

McChrystal Relevance: High rebranding exposure; distinct customer base (dental offices vs. hospitals)

Health Information Systems

Leader: [TBD]

Function: Healthcare IT, coding, data analytics

McChrystal Relevance: IT separation from 3M creates unique technology transformation

Finance

Leader: Wayde McMillan, CFO

Function: Financial transformation, debt management, cost program

McChrystal Relevance: Cost transformation governance; activist reporting

Human Resources

Leader: Anita Zielinski, SVP CHRO

Function: Culture, talent, organizational design

McChrystal Relevance: Priority: Culture building, change management, organizational design

Technology / IT

Leader: John Banovetz, CTO

Function: IT separation from 3M, standalone systems

McChrystal Relevance: Critical path for TSA expiration; technology infrastructure

Office of the CEO

Leader: Bryan Hanson, CEO

Function: Enterprise strategy, activist management, board governance

McChrystal Relevance: Executive sponsor; manages Trian relationship

Stakeholder Engagement Priority:

1. Mojdeh Poul (EVP MedSurg) - operational leader closest to transformation execution challenges

2. Anita Zielinski (CHRO) - owns organizational design and culture transformation
3. Bryan Hanson (CEO) - executive sponsor, manages activist relationship
4. Wayde McMillan (CFO) - governs cost transformation investment decisions

9f. Opportunity Thesis

Strategic Signal Convergence - Why Now: Spinoff (standalone operating model required) -> Activist pressure (compressed timelines) -> Cost transformation (\$500M target demands cross-functional coordination) -> Rebranding (2027 deadline creates urgency) -> Acquisition integration (competing for leadership bandwidth). Each signal compounds the organizational complexity of the others. The convergence creates a 12-18 month window where external operating model expertise is both needed and fundable.

The Structural Paradox - Why McChrystal, Not McKinsey: McKinsey and BCG are almost certainly engaged on the cost transformation strategy. Deloitte likely handles IT separation. Korn Ferry may advise on leadership assessment. But none of these firms build operating models - they deliver recommendations. Solventum's challenge isn't knowing what to do (they have McKinsey for that); it's building the organizational machinery that coordinates execution across six simultaneous transformation workstreams. That's McChrystal's exact lane - the gap between strategy and execution.

Phased Engagement Hypothesis - Land and Expand:

- Phase 1 (Months 1-3, \$400K-\$500K): Enterprise Operating Rhythm Design - map current cross-functional coordination gaps, design the operating cadence, and pilot with the rebranding program (chosen because it touches every function and has a hard deadline). Beachhead: the rebranding program is visible, urgent, cross-functional, and has clear measurable outcomes - making it easy to demonstrate value.
- Phase 2 (Months 4-9, \$1M-\$1.5M): Enterprise-wide deployment of operating rhythm across all transformation workstreams. Integration of cost program, IT separation, and acquisition coordination into unified cadence.
- Phase 3 (Months 10-18, \$500K-\$1M retainer): Ongoing transformation cadence management, leadership team coaching, and board/activist reporting framework.

Competitive Displacement Strategy: Don't compete with McKinsey on cost strategy or Deloitte on IT. Position McChrystal as the 'connective tissue' that makes all existing advisory investments more effective. Frame: "You've spent \$X million on strategy and IT - McChrystal ensures those investments produce coordinated outcomes rather than parallel workstreams." Entry through procurement: position as organizational effectiveness (not strategy consulting) to avoid incumbent advisor territory.

Multi-Threaded Pursuit Map:

- Thread 1: Mojdeh Poul (EVP MedSurg) - rebranding coordination challenge as entry point. Angle: "How is the 3M logo removal program being coordinated across manufacturing, regulatory, and sales?" Appeal: she feels the pain daily of cross-functional misalignment.
- Thread 2: Anita Zielinski (CHRO) - culture and organizational design. Angle: "How are you building shared identity across 22,000 people who still think of themselves as 3M?" Appeal: culture transformation is her mandate.
- Thread 3: Board/Trian connection - if any McChrystal partners have Trian or Nelson Peltz connections, a board-level introduction that frames McChrystal as "the firm that ensures transformation execution matches transformation ambition."
- Warm Introduction Vectors: McChrystal personal network in healthcare leadership; military/veteran connections among Solventum leadership (check bios); conference proximity at J.P. Morgan Healthcare Conference or AdvaMed.